

PICKLING



Kids (under 10)

Q

**What do you usually see
inside a jar of pickles?**

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Cucumbers soaked in vinegar or salty water

FUN FACT

Pickles are made when cucumbers take a bath in vinegar or salty water!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Kids (under 10)

Q

When cucumbers are turned into pickles in a jar, what color do they usually change to?

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ANSWER

A darker, dull green

FUN FACT

Cucumbers start out bright green, but when they're pickled, they turn into a darker green color!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

Which smell is strongest when you open a jar of pickles?

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Tangy, sour vinegar smell

FUN FACT

Vinegar gives pickles their yummy tangy smell!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

What do you feel when you touch a freshly made pickle?

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

A firm and crunchy texture

FUN FACT

Good pickles stay crunchy and fun to eat!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

What does a grown-up never do when making pickles with vinegar?

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Use less vinegar than the recipe says

FUN FACT

Vinegar is super important to keep pickles safe and tasty!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

What is the salty water called that grown-ups use to soak cucumbers to turn them into pickles?

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ANSWER

Brine

FUN FACT

Brine is like a salty bath that helps cucumbers stay crunchy and yummy when they become pickles!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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What color is the vinegar usually used for pickling vegetables?

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ANSWER

Clear or white

FUN FACT

White vinegar is common for making pickles sour and safe.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

How long do fermented pickles like sauerkraut take to get ready?

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ANSWER

Several weeks to develop flavor

FUN FACT

Fermented pickles need patience as they slowly get sour and tasty!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

What does a 'weight' do when your family ferments vegetables in a crock?

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ANSWER

Keeps the vegetables under the salty water

FUN FACT

A heavy plate or bag keeps veggies under water so good bacteria grow!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

If you see bubbles and a sour smell coming from fermented vegetables, what does it mean?

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ANSWER

They are safely fermenting and getting tangy

FUN FACT

Bubbles and sour smells happen when good bacteria make yummy pickles.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

When making quick pickles, how long does it usually take to pickle the vegetables?

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Only 1 or 2 days

FUN FACT

Quick pickles are ready fast because they use vinegar to get sour quickly.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

What should never touch your pickles to keep them safe and yummy?

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Utensils made of zinc, copper, or iron

FUN FACT

Some metals can make pickles turn weird colors or go bad, so we don't use them!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

When you see cucumbers in a jar covered with a sour, salty water, what do you think that water is called?

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Pickling juice

FUN FACT

The special sour and salty water helps cucumbers change into tasty pickles!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

If you notice some fuzzy or moldy spots floating on the juice with pickles, what do grown-ups usually do to keep the pickles good?

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ANSWER

They gently scoop off the fuzzy stuff and keep the pickles covered in the juice.

FUN FACT

A little fuzzy mold on top can be carefully taken off so the pickles stay yummy and safe to eat!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Kids (under 10)

Q

Why do cucumber pickles often have a little piece cut off the blossom end before pickling?

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

To prevent soft spots and help them stay crunchy

FUN FACT

Removing a tiny end bit helps pickles be firmer and crunchier!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Kids (under 10)

Q

What kind of jars do grown-ups use to keep pickles safe during canning?

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Special Mason jars made for canning

FUN FACT

Mason jars are made for preserving food safely with lids that seal tight.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Which of these is a type of fermented pickle you might see at a farmers market?

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ANSWER

Sauerkraut or kimchi

FUN FACT

Sauerkraut and kimchi are veggies that get tangy from natural fermentation!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Kids (under 10)

Q

What does a 'fresh pack' pickle mean?

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ANSWER

Putting fresh vegetables directly into hot vinegar before canning

FUN FACT

Fresh pack pickles go into hot vinegar to be tasty and safe quickly!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

If vinegar used for pickling is not strong enough, what could happen to the pickles?

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Bad bacteria could grow and spoil the food

FUN FACT

Strong vinegar stops bad germs from growing in your pickles.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

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Q

When you open a sealed jar of homemade pickles, what might you hear?

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

A little pop sound as the jar seal breaks

FUN FACT

That pop means the jar was sealed tight and kept your pickles fresh!

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables